

Palau International Ship Registry



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MARINE CIRCULAR 192.1

To: ALL SHIPOWNERS, MANAGERS, MASTERS, AND REGISTRATION OFFICERS OF MERCHANT SHIPS AND RECOGNIZED ORGANIZATIONS.

Subject: END OF LIFE OF ISAT M2M

1. Reference
 - 1.1 INMARSAT and ORBCOMM (previously SKYWAVE) Official Notification.
2. Purpose
 - 2.1 The purpose of this Marine Circular is to inform shipowners and ship managers of the changes of services provided by IsatM2M satellite, including equipment and navigational areas affected and updated status of the dates to its end of life.
3. Applicability
 - 3.1 This Marine Circular applies to all vessels that have the following equipment installed for the compliance of the LRIT and SSAS:
 - Skywave DMR-800 (for general tracking) being replaced by ST 6100
 - Skywave DMR-800 (for LRIT compliance) being replaced by Sirius One
 - Pole Star DSAS Mk1 (for SSAS compliance) being replaced by DSAS Mk2
4. General Information
 - 4.1 ORBCOMM (previously Skywave) had confirmed that the IsatM2M satellite service provision was due to be terminated on December 31st, 2020, however, due the current COVID19 situation, the termination was extended until December 31st, 2021.
 - 4.2 ORBCOMM have now provided confirmation that the IsatM2M service for the Pacific Ocean Region (POR) is excluded from this extension, and service for this region will end on December 31st, 2020.
 - 4.3 Therefore, the Skywave DMR-800 or DSAS Mk1 equipment will no longer operate while the vessel's transceiver is located in the North Pacific Ocean, Bering Sea, Sea of Okhotsk, Philippine Sea, Coral Sea, Tasman Sea, and South Pacific Ocean (Inmarsat I3 Pacific Ocean Region).
 - 4.4 ORBCOMM have stated that the remaining IsatM2M service will continue on a "best efforts basis", despite the risk of aging network elements. However, there is a concern that the IsatM2M service may prove insufficient for critical position reporting services, even outside of the Pacific Ocean Region (POR) and it is expected to be subjected to transmission gaps.



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5. Further Actions

- 5.1 Taking into account the importance in the LRIT Compliance, this Administration kindly ask you to take all the measurements needed, including quoting of new equipment, and coordination of its installation and testing, in order to ensure that the compliance with the LRIT is not interrupted.
- 5.2 If your vessel is navigating within the Pacific Ocean Region (POR) you are required to submit to this Administration confirmation of receipt of this Marine Circular together with the information regarding the new equipment to be installed and the time frame for the change of the equipment. The LRIT transmission shall not be interrupted after December 31st, 2020 and therefore all efforts to avoid the interruption are expected.
- 5.3 If your vessel has the equipment described in section 3.1 but is not navigating in the Pacific Ocean Region (POR), you need to start the migration process at the earliest in order to avoid transmission interruption as communicated by ORBCOMM. Any transmission interruption will be questioned, and full cooperation is expected from the owners and managers of the vessel.

6. Contact

- 6.1 Any inquiries concerning the subject for this Marine Circular should be directed to the Palau Ship Registry Administrator at technical@palaureg.com

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